

The Approval Router

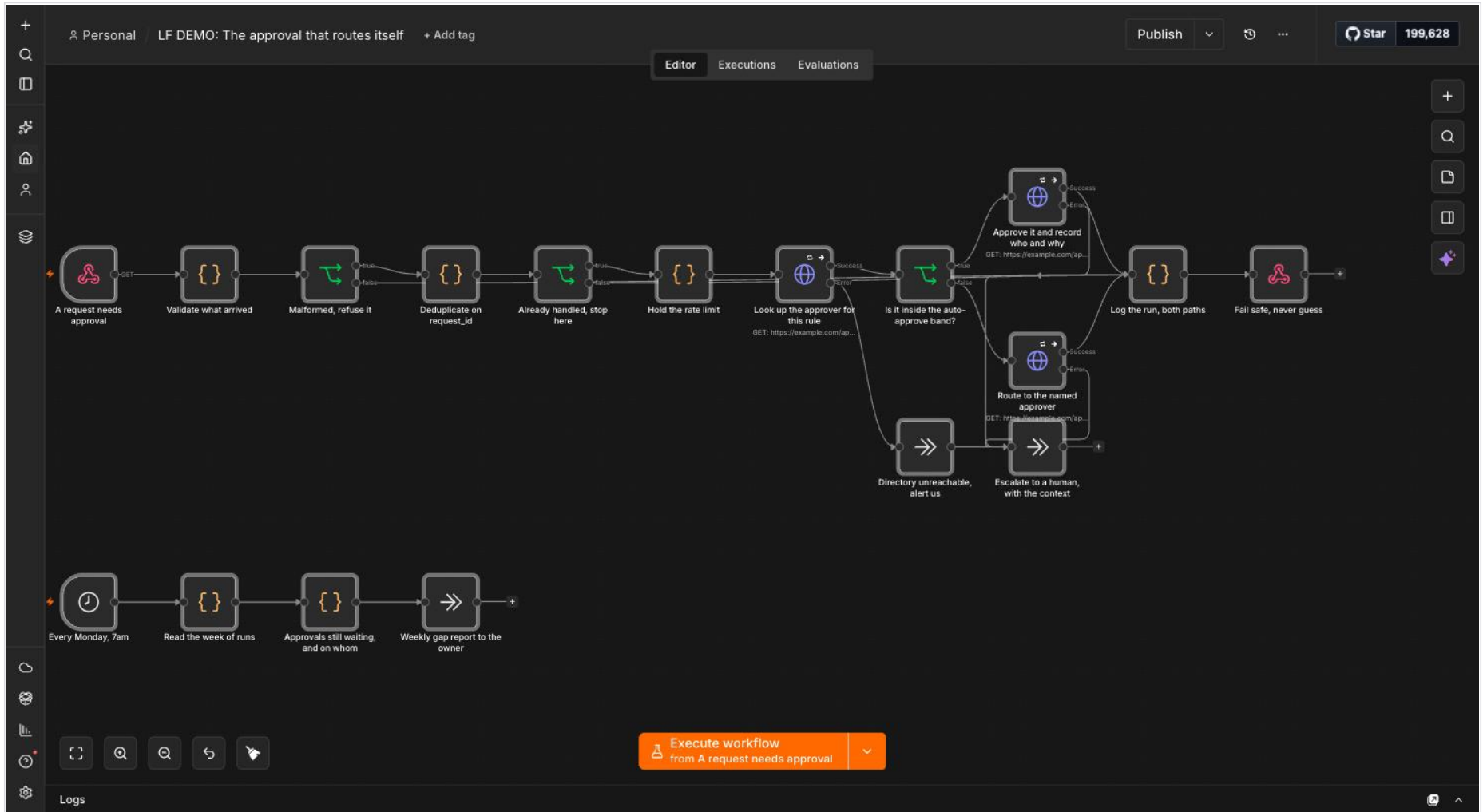
approval-routing · built in n8n

Approvals sit in an inbox with no ladder, so the bottleneck is invisible until someone asks why nothing shipped.

What it connects to: The request arrives in one place and the authority to approve lives in another. The audit trail has to span both or the band is unauditabile.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the router: auto-approve inside a band, route the rest by rule, escalate on silence.



2 of 4 THINKING

Every auto-approval records who and why, or the band becomes unauditale.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a node titled "Is it inside the auto-approve band?". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters Section: Contains tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings". Under "Parameters", there is a "Conditions" section with a JSON expression: `{{ $json.withinBand === true && $json.approver != null && $json.amount > 0 }}`. A dropdown menu shows "is true". Below the conditions is a toggle switch for "Convert types where required" which is currently turned off. There is also an "Options" section with a "+ Add option" button.

OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "to view output data".

At the bottom of the Parameters section, there is a text input field with the placeholder "I wish this node would...".

The interface includes a sidebar on the left with various icons and a top bar with a "Docs" link and a close button.

3 of 4 RESULT

And the weekly report naming who's actually holding things up.

The screenshot displays the Node-RED web interface for configuring a node titled "Look up the approver for this rule". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Settings, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Shows "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Settings Section: Contains configuration options for the node:

- Parameters:** Includes toggle switches for "SSL Certificates", "Always Output Data", "Execute Once", and "Retry On Fail" (which is currently enabled).
- Max. Tries:** A text input field containing the value "3".
- Wait Between Tries (ms):** A text input field containing the value "2000".
- On Error:** A dropdown menu set to "Continue (using error output)".
- Notes:** A large text area for adding notes, currently empty.
- Display Note in Flow?:** A toggle switch that is currently disabled.
- Version:** A note indicating "HTTP Request node version 4.2 (Latest version: 4.5)".
- Footer:** A link that says "I wish this node would..."

OUTPUT Section: Shows "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "or set mock data". Above this, there are two informational messages: "This node will automatically retry if it fails" and "Execution will continue even if the node fails".

The top of the interface includes a title bar with a globe icon and the node name, and a "Docs" link. The bottom of the interface has a "Logs" tab.

4 of 4 MORE

And the weekly report naming who's actually holding things up.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface with a dark theme. The central node is titled "Deduplicate on request_id". It has two tabs: "Parameters" and "Settings". The "Parameters" tab is active, showing a "Mode" dropdown set to "Run Once for All Items", a "Language" dropdown set to "JavaScript", and a "JavaScript" code editor. The code editor contains the following JavaScript code:

```
1 // The same event arrives twice more often than anyone expects.  
2 const key = $json["request_id"];  
3 const seen = $getWorkflowStaticData('global');  
4 seen.keys = seen.keys || {};  
5 const isNew = !seen.keys[key];  
6 seen.keys[key] = Date.now();  
7 return [{ json: { ...$json, isNew, dedupeKey: key } }];
```

Below the code editor is a tooltip that says: "Type \$ for a list of special vars/methods. Debug by using console.log() statements and viewing their output in the browser console." To the right of the code editor is an "Execute step" button. The left panel shows the "INPUT" section with a "No input data" message and an "Execute previous nodes" button. The right panel shows the "OUTPUT" section with a "No output data" message and an "Execute step" button. The bottom of the interface has a "Logs" section.